Millen Woods School Council
October 9, 2024 Meeting Minutes

Welcome & Introductions: Ashley

- Meeting called to order at 6:35 PM
- Review and approval of Agenda: Erin
- Review and approval of the October minutes: Emily

Admin Report: Karen

- Results of the board's assessment on whether there will need to be a reorganization across schools based on Ministry caps on class sizes
    - We've managed to avoid a re-organization this year
    - 1 child moved into a French immersion stream at another school, allowing us to move one student from a grade 1 classroom into a ½ split to meet caps
- Enrollment is down in the board; 1,000 fewer students enrolled than anticipated
- Raised $3,000+ for the Terry Fox Run; Karen wore a dino costume to celebrate the "dino-mite" results
- The pirate ship playground structure is coming down this week; the center structure in the middle is being removed, and the "ends of the boat" are staying
- Potentially a gaga ball pit replacing the pirate ship but waiting to hear from the Board on that possibility
- Math Achievement Plan
    - Instructors are doing 4 days of instruction, followed by a purposeful practice day where the teacher meets groups of students based on assessments for a "coach's corner" together
    - This initiative is a bit more prescribed in what materials teachers are using and is designed to help students who are struggling with those topics
- We have the opportunity to have an Early Reading Resource teacher come to the school to help our teachers, they will return at the end of Oct for a 5-week block to help teachers read the data they've gotten from the students and figure out how to help the students moving forward.
- Extended Day is being run by the Board this year (previously, it was run by JHCCC); it seems to be going well. It's a big adjustment for the teachers/classrooms involved, but the kids seem happy and well-adjusted. A bulletin board to communicate more regularly about it is being set up.
- PALS and soccer are going well
- EQAO results were great, we were ranked 8.6/10, Millen was featured in a news article
    - *Refer to the attached document for the results presented*
    - Math is our biggest opportunity for growth, hence the Math Achievement Plan outlined earlier
    - Doing lots of targeted assessments to ensure all kids are getting what they need; in some cases, those who scored lower actually have good grades in those subjects, they just don't perform well on formal tests.
- We got all new LED lights throughout the school; huge energy savings for the Board.

- The large divots along the perimeter of the path around the school have been fixed; more work needs to get done around the basketball nets, but those aren't a priority right now for the Board.

Finance Report: Raj

- *See report attached*
- Totals brought in
    - ESNS $2,600 (final cheque from 2023-2024 school year)
        - We surpassed what we budgeted for revenue by approx. $2,000
    - Mabels Labels $128, we've already surpassed what we budgeted for (Budget value $100)
    - Popcorn $694
- Expenses
    - Playground bins $720 (2023-2024 expense)
    - Enrichment: Bussing $509 (2023-2024 expense)
    - Track and Field: Bussing $509 (standard price for 2 buses) (2023-2024 expense)
- Total balance: $54,491.26 (between WEFI and Council accounts)
    - A lot of this is going to the playground, projected cost is $50-55K per the RFP issued by the Board

Meet the Community/Book Fair – Feedback

- Earnings:
    - FoCheezy didn't end up meeting their $1,000 threshold, so we didn't get the 10% back from them
    - $170 coming in from MegaCone and El Milagro
- Food truck feedback:
    - There's always a line at Megacone
    - Potentially look at reducing to 1 savoury and 1 sweet truck to ensure we meet the truck minimums for donation back to the School
    - Let's try less 'meal' foods, more 'snack' foods next year
        - Crumby Cookie
        - A fry truck
- Bookfair feedback:
    - Many parents asked if they could come to the book fair early, at dropoff, instead of after school to avoid the rush. School Day post indicated the hours the Book Fair was open for shopping, which included the before dropoff time, next year will make this more clear for families.
    - Cash register reactions: some prices felt high (not books, the accessories)
- We got $2,500 back from Scholastic (about 50% is our profit).
- LBP made their book fair a little later, and we'd like to book early next year again to capture the audience (Ashley's already booked it); it's a real draw for the school and lets Mrs. Devereaux meet families and showcase the library as part of the Meet the Community event.

Action item: Prep volunteers more next year

Kindie Playground - Status Update: Karen

- No update

PRO Grant – Discussion

- Parents Reaching Out Grant that funds parent involvement with students
- In previous years, we've done Guest Speakers and ESQ STEM nights. ESQ typically builds a program to match the funding available. Last year ESQ offered the school free programs for during the day, which were taken advantage of by staff.
- We can wait to see if a PRO Grant does surface, but you do have to apply for it to release the funds for use; some programs are built for PRO Grants
- Could tie the ESQ to Winter Wonderland to make it a bigger event to draw people; in the past, ESQ wanted to use the gym for some activities, so maybe a less ideal pairing.
- In the last couple of years, we've done 'sciency' things, might be nice to alternate with art.
- ArtShine used to do lessons at the school; it's a program that costs families money and can take place during the school day or after; problematic because it highlights inequities; Karen's put them on hold but they might be great to come in and host for PRO Grant like event.
- Ideas: paint night, "kool-aid & canvases", a clay molding class (self-hardening), artistic expression

Action item: Karen to contact ArtShine to see whether they have a PRO Grant program planned for this year.

Snack & Lunch Program: Ashley

- Popcorn's ordered; first day is October 18
- Pizza Depot supplied pizza this past Tuesday
    - They approached us last year asking for the opportunity, we did a tester with them last June and the taste was great but there were quality issues, they committed to fixing them but this Tuesday the issues persisted
        - Slices not equal, toppings inconsistent, bubbles, missing bits of cheese
        - Boxes were not organized by class, more work for our staff
        - Kids didn't like it, said it was "gross", and lots of pizza went home in lunches
- Dominos has been great previously and a big supporter of our school
- Little Caesar's and New Orleans have also been successful providers in the past

Action item: Ashley to provide Pizza Depot with clear feedback again, and likely switch vendors back to Dominos.

Action item: Ashley to contact ESNS to see whether other schools have experienced issues with Pizza Depot and change the schedule to include only Dominos for pizza moving forward.

Spirit Wear Discussion - Potential Fall Fundraiser: Karen

- The Board doesn't have a bid or proposal for Spiritwear; it's up to us to ensure it's a reputable vendor that has insurance in case it goes bankrupt, etc.
- Sweatshirts and T-shirts is the idea, bringing something fresh and new

- Potentially council can set aside some funds to support any families who can't afford to participate; can also ask families to contribute an extra $5+ to go to other families
- Maybe include hats, and mitts to add different price points
- 2022 vendors that LBP investigated included: Spiritwear Canada, Sportslink in Kitchener (unresponsive in 2022), Canadian Custom Apparel, Lasting Images
- VistaPrint has worked well for Rachel before; look into whether they support fundraisers, beware of shipping costs, and if we want to support local or not

Action item: Karen to contact Alison from LPB for feedback on 2022 spirit wear vendors

Action item: Rachel to price out some items through VistaPrint

Winter Clothing Drive

- Quite a few donations already!
- Sending proceeds to Forest Hill, who is excited to refill their "clothing closet"
- Extending the deadline to Tuesday, October 15 to give families the long weekend to do a final browse of their closets.

Action item: Karen is to send a reminder tomorrow about the Winter Clothing Drive and notify everyone that the end date has been extended to Tuesday, October 15

Walking Only School Designation

- On hold

Fundraising Brainstorming

- Thinking of Spirit Wear for the fall fundraiser then will have two more fundraising events in 2025, one usually March-ish, and one near the end of the school year
- The Dance-a-thon has been done many times over the past ~6 years and is starting to get a little stale for the older kids
    - Could still do it, just re-think the format for the older grades
    - It's an expense to us, $500 for the DJ, $500 for the photo booth (we make it back, but it cuts into our profits)
    - Photobooth is always a hit
- Read-a-thon has been done previously
- Maybe balancing events – dance-a-thon every other year
- Something active would be great and during school hours
- Ideas:
    - Art auction
    - Room talent show could set classroom fundraising goals
        - Staff challenge at the end is a fun idea ("if we raise our target, something fun happens")
    - Games in the gym (cornhole, ladder ball, carnival games), prizes
- Spring fundraiser:
    - MacMillan's last year, everyone loves it but it's a lot of effort and a lower profit fundraiser
    - Purdy's or Reid's for non-Easter-themed chocolate

Action item: Survey school families about what fundraisers they'd like to see in the new year

- Erin will source the content, Rachel will create the survey
- Likely use a Google Form
- Send out in the new year
- Include a price point question

Winter Wonderland - Form Sub-Committee

- 2025 date: Jan 14, -6 pm-7:30 pm
- Sub-committee volunteers: Pradeep, Emily, Kristen, Sarah, Rachel, Daniella

School Photos

- Last year we switched from Life Touch to Edge Imaging Photos, they had good packages
- Life Touch has come back to us seeking our business again, they offer:
  - Kickback option to offer families who haven't purchased photos to buy them at a lower cost
  - Principal scholarship program; donation to school council
  - Sibling photos in the Spring
  - Proprietary lighting
  - But requires a 3-year contract with the school
- Feedback:
  - The quality of Edge is a bit better, but don't love that they tell kids to "smile little"
  - When comparing packages, compare digital package prices, a lot of families only purchase the digital image

Action item: Karen to contact Edge to see if they will donate funds back to match Lifetouch's offering.

Adjournment

- The meeting was adjourned at 7:59 pm

Next meeting: Nov 13th at 6:30 pm in person and with a virtual option

MILLEN WOODS SCHOOL COUNCIL
ATTENDANCE SHEET FOR October 9, 2024

#	Name	Position	Email	Initial for Attendance
1.	Karen Grant-O'Grady	Principal	karen_grantogrady@wrdsb.ca	KGO
2.	Ashley Feeney	Co-Chair	ashleylfeeney@gmail.com	AF
3.	Emily Lutz	Co-Chair	emilywyss@gmail.com	EL
4.	Erin Evans	Co-Secretary	erinnfranklin@gmail.com	EE
5.	Steph Honour	Co-Secretary	stephaniemhonour@gmail.com	SH
6.	Raj Pancha	Treasurer	Rajathepan@hotmail.com	RP
7.	Sarah Nickel	Co-Communications Officer	nickelsarahm@gmail.com	SN (online)
8.	Rachel Sarchielli	Co-Communications Officer	sarchrachel@gmail.com	RS
9.	Jake Billo	Technology Officer	jake@billo.ca	JB (online)
10.	Colleen Araya	Volunteer Coordinator	colleenmw@hotmail.com	Regrets
11.	Dan Collens	Voting	dan.collens@gmail.com	DC
12.	Pradeep Chandran	Voting	pradeep24s@gmail.com	Regrets
13.	Kristen Smith	Voting	kj_martin@hotmail.com	KS (online)
14.	Daniella Cross-Henderson	Voting	daniellacross@gmail.com	DC (online)
15.	Julia Klein	Voting	julia.kleinhb@gmail.com	Regrets
16.	Maryam Elsabagh	Voting	maryam_rashad@hotmail.com	Regrets
17.	Nicolas Mellet	Voting	nicolas.mellet@net.com	
18.	Sandra Ribes	Voting	mrs.s.ribes@gmail.com	SR (online)
19.	Sarah Boss	Non-Voting	Slouboss@gmail.com	
20.	Hamed Hashemi	Non-Voting	s.h.hashemi65@gmail.com	
21.	Michael Da Silva		michaeljdasilva@gmail.com	
22.	Meaghan McGloin		meaghan.mcgloin@gmail.com	
23.				
24.				
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Millen Woods

EQAO 2023-24 Brief Summary		Grade 3	Grade 6
Reading	School	22 / 78	100
	Province	29 / 71	18 / 82
Writing	School	18 / 82	100
	Province	36 / 63	20 / 80
Math	School	24 / 76	19 / 81
	Province	39 / 61	50 / 50
22% are not meeting the provincial target of a B or Level 3, 78% are .			

Millen Woods Public School
School Council
Monthly Report 2024/25

	September	October	November	December	January	February	March	April	May	June	September	YTD totals	Budget 2023/2024	
Opening Balance School Council Account	26,974.56	28,730.62	28,730.62	28,730.62	28,730.62	28,730.62	28,730.62	28,730.62	28,730.62	28,730.62	28,730.62	28,730.62		
Opening Balance WEFI Account	25,760.64	25,760.64	25,760.64	25,760.64	25,760.64	25,760.64	25,760.64	25,760.64	25,760.64	25,760.64	25,760.64	25,760.64		
Fundraising Activities (Revenue)														
WEFI Donations												0.00	0.00	
ESNS (Lunches - Tuesday, Thursday, 1 Friday a month)	2,673.65											2,673.65	5,500.00	
Mabel's Labels (ongoing)	128.40											128.40	100.00	
TruEarth (ongoing)												0.00	0.00	
Factory Shoes (ongoing)												0.00	300.00	
Meet the Community (Sept)												0.00	200.00	Food Trucks
Fall Fundraiser (Oct)												0.00	1,000.00	
Winter Wonderland (January)												0.00	200.00	Pizza Sales
Winter Fundraiser (March)												0.00	5,000.00	Dance-a-thon?
Movie Night (April)												0.00	0.00	
Year-End Social & Spring Fundraiser (June 11)												0.00	500.00	
Popcorn Sales	694.00											694.00	6,400.00	
Ice Cream Sandwich Sales												0.00	0.00	
HST Rebates												0.00	0.00	
Fundraising Activities total (School Account)	**3,496.05**	**0.00**	**0.00**	**0.00**	**0.00**	**0.00**	**0.00**	**0.00**	**0.00**	**0.00**	**0.00**	**0.00**	**3,496.05**	
Fundraising Activities total (WEFI)	**0.00**	**0.00**	**0.00**	**0.00**	**0.00**	**0.00**	**0.00**	**0.00**	**0.00**	**0.00**	**0.00**	**0.00**	**0.00**	
Fundraising Total (both accounts)	**$3,496.05**	**$0.00**	**$0.00**	**$0.00**	**$0.00**	**$0.00**	**$0.00**	**$0.00**	**$0.00**	**$0.00**	**$0.00**	**$0.00**	**$3,496.05**	**19,200.00**
Expenses														
General Administration												0.00	500.00	
Home & Classroom reading												0.00	1,500.00	
Grade 6 Graduation												0.00	200.00	
Playground bins (13 classes x $75)	$720.93											720.93	500.00	refill in spring 2025
Musical Instruments Reserve												0.00	200.00	piano tuning
Extracurricular Clubs												0.00	0.00	
Playground Maintenance												0.00	0.00	
Donation to another School												0.00	0.00	
Enrichment - School Trips/Transportation	$509.53											509.53	2,500.00	allocated $200/class
Enrichment - School Events or Resources												0.00	5,000.00	
Dance-a-thon												0.00	1,000.00	DJ and photobooth
Area Track Meet Bussing	$509.53											509.53	500.00	
Popcorn Purchase												0.00	2,500.00	
Student Subsides												0.00	100.00	
Athletics Requests												0.00	500.00	carry year over year
Grounds Maintenance (plants, mulch, garden supplies)												0.00	750.00	
Winter Wonderland												0.00	1,200.00	
Playground Improvement												0.00	1,500.00	carry year over year ... Gaga Ball Pit $3000
Expenses total	**1,739.99**	**0.00**	**0.00**	**0.00**	**0.00**	**0.00**	**0.00**	**0.00**	**0.00**	**0.00**	**0.00**	**0.00**	**1,739.99**	**18,450.00**
Ending Balance School Council Account	**28,730.62**	**28,730.62**	**28,730.62**	**28,730.62**	**28,730.62**	**28,730.62**	**28,730.62**	**28,730.62**	**28,730.62**	**28,730.62**	**28,730.62**	**28,730.62**	**28,730.62**	
Ending Balance WEFI Account	**25,760.64**	**25,760.64**	**25,760.64**	**25,760.64**	**25,760.64**	**25,760.64**	**25,760.64**	**25,760.64**	**25,760.64**	**25,760.64**	**25,760.64**	**25,760.64**	**25,760.64**	
Total Balance	**$54,491.26**	**$54,491.26**	**$54,491.26**	**$54,491.26**	**$54,491.26**	**$54,491.26**	**$54,491.26**	**$54,491.26**	**$54,491.26**	**$54,491.26**	**$54,491.26**	**$54,491.26**	**$54,491.26**	**750.00**